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IN BRIEF

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Anthony Ha

UK starts enforcing online age-check rules

A U.K. law requiring that pornography websites verify the age of their users took effect Friday.

[The BBC reports](#) that around 6,000 porn sites have said they will start verifying users' ages to comply with the [Online Safety Act](#), although at least one major site was not requiring age checks as of Friday morning.

The law also requires that online platforms prevent children from being exposed to harmful content, which is why sites [like Reddit](#), Bluesky, X, and Grindr have also begun asking users in the U.K. to verify their age through means including selfies or government-issued IDs.

This is just one of a number of new child protection laws that could normalize online age checks globally, [according to Wired](#). The approach has

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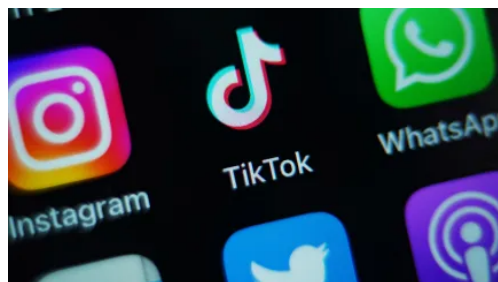
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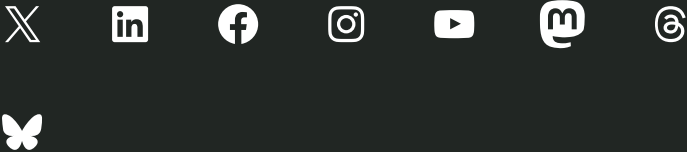
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